

The grant was most of it. It was not all of it.

A \$3 million project in Clarksdale, and the biggest cheque covered about three quarters. The rest is the part most applicants never plan for.

ONE DEAL

On 6 August, Higher Purpose Hub broke ground on a regional economic opportunity centre at 238 Issaquena Avenue in Clarksdale, Mississippi. The project is about \$3 million. A Delta Regional Authority grant of more than \$2.2 million is behind it, and the balance came from foundations and donors.

That is a real building, in a Delta town, on a street you can drive down.

ONE LESSON

Look at the shape of the money rather than the size of it.

The DRA grant is roughly three quarters of the project. **The last quarter came from somewhere else, and it had to be found before the first quarter could be spent.** Almost every funder asks the same question in some form: who else is in, and for how much. A grant application that answers "nobody yet, we are asking you for all of it" is answering the question badly.

This is the part that catches good organisations. They find a programme, they read the maximum award, they write the application for the maximum, and they lose to somebody who asked for less and showed where the rest was coming from. The winning application is usually not the most ambitious one. It is the one that looks finishable.

The other thing worth noticing: foundations and individual donors closed the gap. Not another federal programme. Those are slower to secure and they need a relationship that does not exist yet on the day you decide to apply.

ONE MOVE

Before your next application, write down the other two sources on one page — the name, roughly how much, and who you would call there. If you cannot fill in a name, that is your work this month, not the application.

Start the slow money first. Foundation and donor money takes the longest to line up and it is almost always the piece that decides whether the fast money can be spent.

Source: Higher Purpose Hub groundbreaking announcement, 31 July 2026. Confirm current figures with the organisation before quoting them.

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